

The EU PPWR Packaging Regulation: A Practical Compliance Guide

Deadline: 12 August 2026 — EPR registration, recyclability standards, void space limits Includes 7 downloadable tools (country registration checklist, PRO templates, compliance audit)

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English Edition v1.0 · June 2026 Compiled by: Cross-Border Compliance Research Team Based on: EU PPWR Regulation (EU) 2025/40, European Commission Implementation Guidelines, 131 Core FAQs, seller case studies

■ Urgent: 12 August 2026 is the Deadline

From **12 August 2026**, the EU Packaging and Packaging Waste Regulation (PPWR) becomes fully enforceable across all 27 member states.

Every product sold into the EU market with packaging must comply with:

- EPR registration in each target country
- Recyclability grading standards
- Void space ratio limits (≤50% for e-commerce)
- Recycled content targets (phased in by 2030/2040)
- Restricted substances limits (heavy metals, PFAS)

Non-compliance consequences:

- Listing removal from Amazon, Temu, Shein, TikTok Shop
- Customs detention and return (demurrage costs €2,000–€10,000+)
- Regulatory fines up to **6% of annual turnover** or €200,000+ per infringement
- Account suspension across all EU marketplaces

10-day action plan:

Day	Action
1–2	Confirm whether your products fall under PPWR scope (use Appendix A checklist)
3–4	Identify which of the 9 mandatory countries you need to register in (use Appendix B table)
5–7	Complete EPR registration + obtain registration numbers (use Appendix C template)
8	Audit your packaging compliance (void space, hazardous substances, recyclability labels)
9	Submit registration numbers to marketplace back offices
10	Done

****Update commitment:**** If the EU publishes any PPWR implementing measure amendments, buyers will receive an updated version automatically within 30 days.

Chapter 1: What is PPWR and Why Act Now?

1.1 PPWR in One Sentence

PPWR (Packaging and Packaging Waste Regulation) is the **biggest overhaul of EU packaging compliance in nearly 30 years**.

The key change: from "Directive" to "Regulation"

Old Directive 94/62/EC	New Regulation PPWR
Member states transposed into national law	Directly applicable across all 27 EU countries
Enforcement varied widely	Uniform standards EU-wide
Loopholes existed between countries	No national interpretation gaps
Penalties depended on location	One violation can restrict sales across the entire EU

Timeline:

Date	Event
22 January 2025	Regulation published (Regulation (EU) 2025/40)
11 February 2025	Entered into force
12 August 2026	**Fully enforceable across all 27 EU member states (the hard deadline)**
1 January 2030	All packaging must meet recyclability grading standards
1 January 2038	Only A/B grade (highly recyclable) packaging permitted in circulation

1.2 Who Must Comply?

Simply put: if your packaged product enters the EU market, you are a "producer" under PPWR and must comply.

No exceptions. Regardless of:

- Where your company is registered (EU or non-EU)
- Fulfilment method (FBA or FBM/self-ship)
- Sales channel (Amazon, Temu, Shein, TikTok Shop, independent store)
- Packaging type (cardboard box, polybag, bubble mailer, courier bag)

1.3 What Packaging Types Are Covered?

PPWR covers **all packaging**, five categories with no exemptions:

Packaging Type	Definition	Examples
Consumer packaging	Product packaging presented at point of sale	Phone box, clothing hang bag

Group packaging	Secondary packaging grouping multiple units	Shrink-wrap for 6-pack drinks
Transport packaging	Packaging used for shipping	FBA master carton, bubble envelope
Service packaging	Takeaway bags, loose food packaging	Coffee cup sleeve, deli bag
Tied packaging	Multiple materials that cannot be separated manually	Coffee pack with aluminium inner pouch

Chapter 2: Five Core Technical Compliance Standards

2.1 Restricted Substances Limits (Enforceable from 12 August 2026)

Key warning: Food-contact packaging has no transition period. Non-compliant stock must be pulled from the market by the deadline.

Test Item	Limit
Heavy metals (lead, cadmium, mercury, hexavalent chromium) total content	$\leq 100\text{mg/kg}$
Quantitative individual PFAS	$\leq 25\text{ppb}$
Total individual PFAS sum	$\leq 250\text{ppb}$
Polymer PFAS total fluorine content	$\leq 50\text{ppm}$

High-risk materials:

- Low-cost bubble mailers (commonly contain PFAS)
- Composite bags (laminated)
- Coated paper
- Cushioning materials (foam, EPE pearl cotton)

2.2 Packaging Recyclability Grading

Packaging is classified into three recyclability grades:

Grade	Meaning	Requirement from 2030	Requirement from 2038
A	Highly recyclable	All packaging must be A or B grade	Only grade permitted in circulation
B	Moderately recyclable	All packaging must be A or B grade	—
C	Poorly recyclable / non-recyclable	Prohibited from placing on market	—

2.3 Void Space Restrictions (Enforceable from 2030)

E-commerce parcel void space must not exceed 50%.

"Void space" includes:

- Empty space within packaging not occupied by the product
- All cushioning and filling materials (bubble wrap, air pillows, foam inserts)
- Double-wall cartons, hidden false bottoms, unnecessarily oversized packaging (explicitly listed as violations)

2.4 Recycled Content Targets (Phased)

Year	Recycled content in plastic packaging	Beverage bottle special requirement
2030	≥ 30%	≥ 50%
2040	≥ 50%	≥ 70%

Paper, glass, and metal packaging follow parallel recycled content standards.

2.5 Single-Use Packaging Phase-Out

The following single-use packaging types are being progressively eliminated:

- Plastic wrapping for fresh fruit and vegetables
- Packaging for food and drink in catering establishments
- Single-portion condiments (sauces, creamers, sugar sachets)
- Micro-packaging for toiletries
- Plastic carrier bags with wall thickness below 15 microns

Chapter 3: EPR Registration — Step by Step (Core Chapter)

3.1 Nine Countries Requiring Mandatory Registration

Amazon begins mandatory verification of EPR registration numbers from these 9 countries in August 2026:

Country	Registration Authority	Number Format	Average Processing Time
Germany	LUCID / Producer Organisation (PRO)	Assigned by PRO	2–4 weeks
France	Various PROs (Citeo, etc.)	Assigned by PRO	2–6 weeks
Italy	National Registry	Assigned by MAEC	3–6 weeks
Spain	Regional PROs	Assigned by PRO	2–4 weeks
Belgium	Packaging Registry System	Assigned by PRO	2–4 weeks

Netherlands	NAP System	Assigned by PRO	2–4 weeks
Ireland	EPA Registration	Assigned by EPA	4–8 weeks
Poland	Producer Registration System	Assigned by PRO	2–4 weeks
Sweden	Producer Responsibility Organisation	Assigned by PRO	2–4 weeks

****Important:**** There is no single "EU-wide" EPR certificate. You must register separately in each country where you sell.

3.2 The Four-Step EPR Registration Process

Step 1: Determine which countries to register in

- Register in each country where you actually sell products
- Even if you only sell on one Amazon marketplace, cover all target countries

Step 2: Choose a PRO (Producer Responsibility Organisation)

- Each country has multiple PROs to choose from
- Compare pricing, processing speed, and whether they support English
- Recommended providers by country (contact templates in Appendix D)

Step 3: Submit documents + pay fees

- Required documents: company details, product category, estimated packaging weight/quantity, packaging material types
- Fee structure: base registration fee + eco-contribution calculated by packaging weight

Step 4: Obtain registration number + submit to marketplaces

- Once you have the registration number, submit it in each marketplace back office
- Amazon: Account Settings → Manage Your Compliance → enter EPR registration number
- Temu / Shein / TikTok Shop: respective compliance pages in seller centre

3.3 Ongoing Declaration Obligations

Registration is not a one-time event:

Frequency	Declaration Content
Quarterly / Annual	Quantity of packaging placed on market, material types, weight
Continuous	Eco-contribution payments to your PRO
If overdue	Registration lapses, products face removal

Chapter 4: Marketplace Compliance Requirements Compared

4.1 PPWR Execution Standards by Platform

Requirement	Amazon	Temu	Shein	TikTok Shop
EPR registration number	Mandatory	Mandatory	Mandatory	Mandatory
Packaging photos	—	Mandatory	Mandatory	Mandatory
Environmental labels	Required	Required	Required	Required
Recycling symbols	Required	Required	Required	Required
Material labeling	Required	Required	Required	Required
Image specification	—	Has specs	Has specs	Has specs

4.2 Common Mistakes

1. **Non-standard photo submissions:** Over-editing, watermarks, incomplete packaging angles, obscured compliance labels
2. **Confusing multi-marketplace rules:** Image dimensions, composition standards, and review focus differ per platform
3. **Incomplete country registration:** Registered only in Germany but not covering France / Italy / Spain sites
4. **Misjudging transition rules:** Assuming "old packaging can still be sold" — but food-contact packaging has zero transition period

Chapter 5: Transition Rules and Customs Evidence

5.1 Core Transition Rule

PPWR■■■■: packaging that was "**first placed on the EU market**" **before 12 August 2026** is exempt from the new rules.

The key evidence is **import customs clearance date < 12 August**, regardless of where the packaging was sourced.

5.2 Evidence Checklist to Retain

- [] Import customs declaration (showing clearance before 12 August)
- [] Bill of lading / air waybill
- [] EU warehouse inbound receipt (screenshot)
- [] Purchase invoice (supplementary)

5.3 Requirements for New Packaging

All packaging placed on the market from 12 August 2026 onwards must fully comply:

- Recyclable design
- Void space ratio $\leq 50\%$
- Unified pictogram labels
- EPR registration completed + registration number uploaded

Chapter 6: ComplianceCat — Free Online Reference Tool

This guide provides the complete compliance framework and tools. ComplianceCat offers convenient online reference.

6.1 What is ComplianceCat?

ComplianceCat (heguimao.pages.dev) is a free online compliance reference tool that helps you quickly understand product compliance requirements.

Key features:

- Product compliance screening (CE/FCC/PPWR certification requirements)
- Preliminary packaging compliance check
- Certification report reference templates

6.2 How to Use ComplianceCat with This Guide

Need	Recommended Tool
Quick check whether your product needs compliance certification	ComplianceCat online query
Confirm whether your product falls under PPWR scope	Appendix A checklist
Country-by-country EPR registration	This guide Chapter 3 + Appendices B/C/D
Detailed packaging compliance audit	Appendix E self-check form
Multi-marketplace rule comparison	Appendix F comparison table
Execution progress tracking	Appendix G timeline + progress tracker

****Tip:**** ComplianceCat is a reference tool. For the complete compliance path, refer to this guide. EPR registration and compliance testing must be completed through official channels.

Chapter 7: Frequently Asked Questions

Q1: I only sell on Amazon Germany. Do I need to register in multiple countries?

A: At minimum, register in Germany. However, if you also sell on France / Italy / Spain sites, you need country-by-country registration. We recommend registering in all countries where you have actual sales volume.

Q2: How long does EPR registration take?

A: Processing times vary significantly by country — 2 to 8 weeks. Some countries (e.g., Ireland) can take 4–8 weeks. Start early.

Q3: Will marketplaces collect and remit on my behalf?

A: No. Under PPWR, marketplaces no longer handle collection and remittance. You must complete EPR registration, pay fees, and submit registration numbers yourself.

Q4: What is the worst-case consequence of non-compliance?

A: Fines up to 6% of annual turnover + product removal across all EU countries + account compliance risk escalation.

Q5: Are there special requirements for food-contact packaging?

A: Yes. Food-contact packaging has no transition period. Non-compliant stock must be removed from the market by 12 August 2026. Pay extra attention to PFAS limits.

Q6: Do I need third-party testing for my packaging?

A: Recommended. Especially heavy metal testing and PFAS testing, which serve as compliance evidence.

Q7: Is an EU authorised representative required?

A: Under the PPWR trend, non-EU sellers should operate through an EU authorised representative for compliance. While not yet mandatory in all countries, we recommend setting this up proactively.

Appendices: 7 Downloadable Tools

#	Tool	Format	Purpose
A	PPWR Scope Self-Assessment Checklist	PDF (printable)	Confirm in 3 minutes whether your products fall under PPWR scope
B	9-Country EPR Registration Comparison Table	PDF	Registration authorities, timelines, and costs at a glance
C	EPR Registration Document Preparation Checklist	PDF	Item-by-item checklist of materials needed for registration
D	Service Provider Inquiry Email Template	DOCX	Copy-paste template for contacting PROs / service providers
E	Packaging Compliance Self-Audit Form	PDF	Void space, hazardous substances, recyclability — item-by-item check
F	Multi-Marketplace Rule Comparison Table	PDF	Amazon / Temu / Shein / TikTok Shop compliance requirements compared
G	10-Day Action Timeline	PDF	Day-by-day action plan from start to finish

How to access:

These tools are provided as separate downloadable files with your purchase. If you cannot locate them, contact [your email].

About This Guide

This guide was compiled by a cross-border compliance research team with hands-on experience in EU product safety regulations. Content is based on:

- EU PPWR Regulation text (Regulation (EU) 2025/40)
- European Commission Implementation Guidelines (March 2026) and 131 Core FAQs
- Official PRO registration process documentation from each country
- Verified seller case studies from multiple marketplaces

Update Commitment

If the EU publishes any PPWR implementing measure amendments within 30 days of this guide's publication, purchasers will receive an updated version automatically via email.

Disclaimer

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Contact

Questions about this guide:

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****Remember:**** 12 August 2026 is not a suggestion. It's the deadline. Start today.